

PROFILE

Postdoctoral researcher in economics and guest professor at Vrije Universiteit Brussel (VUB).

Research interests: Political economy; democratic representation; political polarisation; computational social science; economics of AI.

EDUCATION

- PhD in Economics, Vrije Universiteit Brussel (2019–2025)
 - o Thesis: Political Economy of Selection and Polarisation: Essays on Electoral Choice, Representation and Voter Turnout
- MSc in Applied Economics, Vrije Universiteit Brussel (2017–2018)
 - o Thesis: Unravelling The Democracy-Growth Nexus: An Empirical Analysis and Institutional explanation
- MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy, MIT (2017)
- BSc in Applied Economics, Vrije Universiteit Brussel (2012–2017)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS AND EXPERIENCE

- Vrije Universiteit Brussel – Postdoctoral Researcher & Visiting Professor (2025–Present)
 - o Course holder for Research Methods for Business.
 - o Master thesis supervisor.
- Vrije Universiteit Brussel – Doctoral Researcher & Teaching Assistant (2019–2025)
 - o Researcher in political economy, electoral choice, and polarisation.
 - o Teaching assistant for microeconomics and public choice.
 - o Supervised undergraduate and graduate research projects.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Al Yussef, A. Turnout and the distortion of representation: the case of electoral polarization. *Public Choice* (2026).
- Al Yussef, A., & Heyndels, B. (2025). Socioeconomic anxieties and electoral polarization: insights from Belgian federal elections at the municipal level. *Acta Politica*, 60, 524–549.
- Al Yussef, A., Heyndels, B., & Le Boulaire, P. (2023). Forever young: Relative age effects in Belgian political selection. *Kyklos*, 76(4), 859–881.
- Al Yussef, A., Heyndels, B., & Le Boulaire, P. (2021). La vie au bureau: Een case study omtrent de evolutie van het publicatiegedrag in de economische wetenschappen. In *Critical Contributions to Economics and Beyond* (pp. 2-16). [1] Lexxion.

WORKING PAPERS AND RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- Al Yussef, A. (2025). A Political Economy of Culture Wars: Polarisation, Sticky Preferences and Mobilisation. *Working paper* [PhD Chapter].
- Al Yussef, A., Méon, P., G. (2026). Divided We Consume: Politics, Norms, and Sentiment in the Marketplace. *Research in Progress*.
- Al Yussef, A. (2026). Ambiguously human: LLMs Over-ideologize Political Statements. *Research in Progress*.
- Al Yussef, A. (2026). Coding Alone: AI and The Unravelling of Collaborative Networks. *Research in Progress*.

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

- DemoTrans Final Conference on Democracy, Globalisation and the Future of Governance, KU Leuven (May 2026)
- European Public Choice Society Meeting, Madrid (March 2026)
- 4th RUCAM Political Economy Workshop, Radboud University Nijmegen (August 2025)
- 3rd RUCAM Political Economy Workshop, Radboud University Nijmegen (August 2024)
- ECPR General Conference, Dublin (August 2024)
- The 6th International Conference on European Economics and Politics, ETH Zurich (June 2024)
- Norwegian Business School (BI), Economics Seminar, Bergen (May 2024)
- VUB APEC Seminar, Brussels (February 2024)

RESEARCH STAYS

- Research Stay at Institute for Economic Analysis (IAE), Barcelona (2025)
 - o Hosted by Prof. Hannes Mueller
- Research Stay at Norwegian Business School (BI), Bergen (2024)
 - o Hosted by Prof. Benny Geys

SKILLS

- Data Science & programming languages: R, Python, Power BI, data visualization
- Human languages: English (C2), Dutch (C2), French (B1/B2), German (Basic comprehension).

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Member, Curriculum Council, Faculty of Social Sciences and Solvay Business School (2021–2025)
- Member, Research Council, Faculty of Social Sciences and Solvay Business School (2023–Present)

REFEREE SERVICE

- *Public Finance Review* (Sage); *De Economist* (Springer Nature); *Public Choice* (Springer Nature);

REFERENCES

- Prof. Dr. Pierre-Guillaume Méon—Université Libre de Bruxelles – p-guillaume.meon@ulb.be
- Prof. Dr. Benny Geys – Norwegian Business School – benny.geys@bi.no
- Prof. Dr. Eva Van Belle – Vrije Universiteit Brussel – eva.van.belle@vub.be
- Prof. Dr. Filip Van Droogenbroeck – Vrije Universiteit Brussel – filip.van.droogenbroeck@vub.be
- Prof. Dr. Bruno Heyndels—Vrije Universiteit Brussel—Bruno.Heyndels@vub.be